UCR Course Design Resources

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Course Components

Info: Seeing a New Button?

When editing a blank Page, Announcement, or anywhere else you see the Canvas Rich Content Editor (RCE), there is now a button labeled "DesignPLUS QuickStart Wizard" to the right of the Title:

Clicking into the QuickStart Wizard will give you the ability to apply Templates and Content Blocks, as well as to move these items around, prior to customizing them for your purposes. Learn more about the DesignPLUS tools through the Cidi Labs DesignPLUS accordion tab of the Intermediate: Course Design and Tools page.

Note: The Wizard will only appear when starting with a blank slate, so to speak. Once there is saved content, the tool will no longer show.

The following are some of the basic components that make up the eLearn (Canvas) online course environment:

Announcements

Announcements allow instructors to reach all students at once.

Info: Resources for Canvas Announcements

- What are Announcements?
- How do I add an announcement in a course?
- How do I attach a file to an announcement in a course?
- How do I edit an announcement in a course?
- How do I set display dates for an announcement in a course?
- How do I copy an announcement to another course?

Caution: Email Notifications from Course Messages and Announcements

Students will not see or receive email notifications from eLearn (Canvas) Course Messages or Announcements until the course is:

1. "Published"
2. Available according to the "Start" date in the "Course Details" tab of the course "Settings."

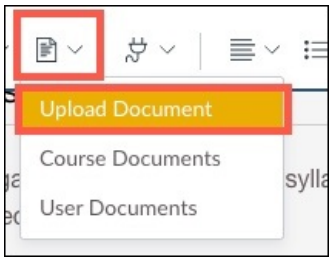
Additionally, instructors do not automatically get CC'd on Course Messages and Announcements through email notifications, but you can enable this in your "Account" → "Notifications" preferences under "Announcement created by you" and "Conversations created by me." Email notifications do not transfer any attachments or images in the Course Messages or Announcements posted.

Syllabus

Here are two options for attaching a syllabus to your course:

1. Use the Syllabus link in the course navigation menu to build your syllabus in HTML format, or upload your syllabus as a document using the "Upload Document" option in the rich text editor. Canvas resource: How do I use the Syllabus as an instructor?

   The dedicated Syllabus page that's linked from the course navigation menu contains a dynamic "Course Summary" to which anything with a due date will populate. However, you can disable the option to "Show Course Summary" when you edit the Syllabus page. Canvas resource: How do I edit the Syllabus in a course?



2. A syllabus document could also be added to a Canvas Module as a stand-alone File. When choosing the option to upload a syllabus document, all updates must be made to the original file, then reuploaded for alignment.

Use one of the following approaches to help you write or adapt your course syllabus:

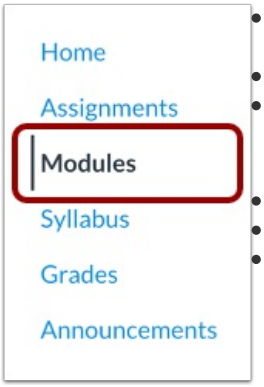
- Import from the **Canvas Commons** "XCITE Syllabus Template 1" (HTML)
  - The "XCITE Course Template 2" (HTML) also contains a syllabus template.
- Download the **document version** of the "XCITE Syllabus Template 1" (Gdoc)

← Find more template options by searching the Canvas Commons through the Canvas Global Navigation Menu. Or read more about course templates under "Getting Started" → "Use a Pre-Designed Template."

As a best practice, we encourage you to upload a copy of your syllabus to UCRâ€™s Syllabus Library. It is a great place to store and share your syllabi with your UCR community.

Modules

Modules create a course structure through which the majority of content is delivered. Organize your modules by week, unit, or topic to sequence and structure your course activities and content. Modules can be used to create a clear path through which students can work. Modules will accommodate different types of items, such as Files, Discussions, Assignments, Quizzes, and other learning materials, such as External URLs. Third-party tools like YuJa Media and publisher integrations can also be added using the "External Tool" option within modules.



- Course content can be added to multiple modules or iterated several times throughout an individual module.
- Modules can be easily organized using the drag-and-drop feature.
- Elements within a module can also be reorganized by dragging and dropping.

Instructors can use Canvas modules to:

- Create prerequisite activities that students must complete before moving on in the course.
- Track student progress through a sequence of learning activities.
- Organize course content by unit, day, week, topic or outcome.

Info: Resources for Canvas Modules

- What are Modules?
- How do I use the modules index page?
- How do I add a module?
- How do I publish or unpublish a module as an instructor?
- How do I duplicate a module?
- How do I copy a module to another course?
- How do I add prerequisites to a module?
- How do I add requirements to a module?
- How do I edit or delete a module?
- How do I lock a module?

Course Structures: Models and Examples

- US History course (by theme)
- Health/Medicine course (by week)
- Education course (by project)
- Psychology course (by unit with expected duration)
- Art Appreciation course (by theme)

Pages

Pages can hold much of the same material as Modules, but appear as a single entry within a Module (when added). Use Pages as a folder to store multiple pieces of content. One page could, for example, store an entire week's worth of content (such as multiple recorded lectures, attached readings, notes, and even assessments for the week).

Pages allow you to edit your content as you go, perhaps adding additional items as you see fit, or updating information. You can also provide context for the various components you attach with supplemental or descriptive text. Pages are helpful for keeping individual Modules short if you are attaching a lot of information.

Info: Resources for Canvas Pages

- How do I publish or unpublish a page as an instructor?
- How do I create a new page in a course?
- How do I edit a page in a course?
- How do I duplicate a page in a course?
- How do I copy a page to another course?
- How do I upload a document in the Rich Content Editor?
- How do I create hyperlinks to course or group content in the Rich Content Editor?
- How do I add a page to the student To-Do list as an instructor?
- How do I embed a video in a page in a course?
- How do I create a file link in a page in a course?
- How do I view the history of a page in a course?

Assignments

Assignments and Discussions can all be categorized as "Assignments" within "Assignment Groups" for the purpose of weighting a total grade. Additionally, any of these kinds of "Assignments" can be inserted into a Module in Canvas. Create and edit an Assignment from within its respective Module or from within the Assignments index page that's linked from the course navigation menu. Instructions for an Assignment should have clear grading criteria. Include expectations for successful Assignment completion, acceptable submission formats, a due date, and instructions on how to submit.

Info: Resources for Canvas Assignments and Rubrics

- What assignment types can I create in a course?
- How do I create an assignment?
- How do I use the Assignments Index Page?
- How do I publish or unpublish an assignment as an instructor?
- How do I weight the final course grade based on assignment groups?
- How do I download all student submissions for an assignment?
- How do I create a peer review assignment?
- What are Rubrics?
- How do I add a rubric in a course?
- How do I add a rubric to an assignment?
- How do I add a rubric to a graded discussion?
- How do I manage rubrics in a course?
- How do I use a rubric to grade submissions in SpeedGrader?
- How do I give extra credit in a course?
- Extra credit using weighted assignment groups

Quizzes

Quizzes are a specific type of Assignment in Canvas. They can be introduced with formatted text, images, video, or sample problems. Instructors can list expectations, along with time limits and grading criteria for students. Quizzes can be built out using migrated question banks, or uploaded materials. Canvas currently supports two types of quizzes, Classic and New. Eventually, New Quizzes are expected to replace Classic Quizzes entirely.

Info: Frequently Asked Questions

New Quizzes

- How do I migrate a Canvas quiz to New Quizzes?
- How do I align an outcome to a quiz in New Quizzes?
- How do I view reports for a quiz in New Quizzes?
- How do I use the Moderation page in New Quizzes?
- How do I import a quiz from a QTI package in New Quizzes?

Classic Quizzes

- How do I add a rubric to a quiz?
- How do I create a question bank in a course?
- How do I export quiz content from a course?
- How do I set up a quiz to be sent to my institution's student information system (SIS)?
- How do I make a quiz available before or after the due date?

Gradebook

In Canvas, the primary place where grading occurs is in the SpeedGrader. The SpeedGrader displays student submissions and provides the tools for feedback as well as the initial entering of grades.

Grades are displayed, however, in the Gradebook. You can also directly enter grades into the table therein (for example, if it is a 'no submission' Assignment).

Info: XCITE-Created Video Resources for Canvas Gradebook

- How to Use Canvas Speedgrader/Turnitin
- 'Creating Columns' in Canvas Gradebook
- Assignment Groups, Dropping Scores, and Weighting Grades
- How to Remove Color Marks in the Gradebook, a.k.a Regrading and Excusing Submissions
- How to Upload Grades with a CSV File
- How to Curve Canvas Grades
- How to Filter the Gradebook by Discussion Sections/Groups
- How to Post Students' Grades
- Understanding Color Coding in Canvas Gradebook
- Canvas SpeedGrader Issue, a.k.a. How to resolve error message RE: student groups

Groups

Groups can facilitate student collaboration. Create them through People, located in the left side menu. These can be used to help students collaborate and submit Assignments.

They are also a useful tool for larger courses because you can use them to filter the Gradebook.

Info: Resources for Canvas Groups

- How do I add a group set in a course?
- How do I automatically create groups in a group set?
- How do I manually create groups in a group set?
- How do I create self sign-up groups in a group set?
- How do I automatically assign students to groups?
- How do I manually assign students to groups?
- How do I move a student into a different group?
- How do I view content and student activity within a group as an instructor?

Discussions

Discussions are a versatile tool with which to increase student interaction and engagement. They enable you to keep the conversation going outside the classroom.

You can control how discussions are displayed as well as options around how students may interact with one another. Important posts so can also be pinned to display at the top of the list.

Info: Resources for Canvas Discussions

- How do I create a discussion as an instructor?
- How do I create a group discussion in a course?
- How do I duplicate a discussion in a course?
- How do I publish or unpublish a discussion as an instructor?
- How do I copy a discussion to another course?
- How do I assign a graded discussion to everyone in a course?
- How do I pin a discussion in a course?
- How do I edit or delete a discussion in a course?
- How do I use peer review discussions in a course?
- How do I edit or delete student discussion replies in a course?
- How do I attach a file to a discussion reply as an instructor?
- How do I link to a YouTube video in a discussion reply as an instructor?
- How do I embed an image in a discussion reply as an instructor?
- How do I allow students to create a course discussion?

Canvas Inbox

The Inbox enables you to send messages to users in your courses. You can choose to email specific individuals, the entire course, or any person holding a particular role in your course. These messages appear in the users' Canvas Inboxes (in the Global Navigation Menu to the far left) rather than in your specific course.

Info: Resources for Canvas Inbox

- How do I use the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I find my unread messages in the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I filter conversations as an instructor?
- How do I star a conversation in the Inbox?
- How do I send a message to a user in a course in the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I send a message to a user in a student group in the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I send a message to all course users in the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I reply to a message in the Inbox as an instructor?
- How do I privately respond to one individual in a group message as an instructor?
- How do I delete a conversation as an instructor?

Important Tip: Available Templates

XCITE Course and Syllabus templates available through the Canvas Commons in the Canvas Global Navigation Menu already contain boilerplate verbiage, prompts, and placeholders for these basic course components.

Available XCITE templates include:

- XCITE Syllabus Template 1 (HTML)
- XCITE Syllabus Template 1 (GDoc)
- XCITE Course Template 1 (HTML)
- XCITE Course Template 2 (HTML)
- Academic Integrity Policy Agreement (HTML)

Read more about templates under "Getting Started" → "Use a Pre-Designed Template."

View the Canvas Instructor Guide (text-based) or Canvas Video Guides for more resources about Canvas features and functionality, or see "Resources and Support."